

PLANAR SUBTYPE CODEX

The 104 Planar States as Spell Sentence Subtypes

A Supplement to the Ætherium Codex

Chapter One: The Planar Subtype System

The Primary Subtypes of the Ætherium Codex define what a spell IS — Fire, Cold, Mind, Death. These remain unchanged. What this codex replaces is the placeholder entry Planar (Verdant Font), Planar (Borderlands), etc., which existed as a category but had no mechanical specificity.

The 104 planar states of the Political Alloy System are not merely geographical facts about the setting — they are distinct cosmological conditions, each one a unique relationship between isotopes of fundamental forces. That uniqueness translates directly into spell-sentence grammar.

Each planar state is now a fully specified Subtype with its own mechanical signature: the specific Effects it pairs with most naturally, the Additives it makes cheaper or more expensive, the conditions it inflicts or prevents, and the rules it bends. A caster with Subtype Tier in The Mycelium casts fundamentally different spells than one with Subtype Tier in Plague, even though both are Verdant Font Myco-dominant states.

How Planar Subtypes Work

A Planar Subtype functions identically to any Primary Subtype in the spell sentence. It fills the Subtype slot, governs Subtype Tier progression, and determines the spell's elemental/conceptual nature. The mechanical signature entries below define the specific rules that apply when this Subtype is used.

Casters gain Subtype Tier in a specific planar state through: extended exposure to that plane's territory (Alpha radiation), dedicated study of that plane's expression (Beta radiation from practice), or birth/transformation in a planar-aligned environment. The same progression rules as any Subtype Tier apply.

Reading the Tables

Each table entry has five fields:

1. Code — the canonical planar code from the Political Alloy System
2. Name — the planar state's canonical name
3. Type — ◆ natural, ✧ catalyzed (requires Forge-access or special talent), CP ◆ cross-planar natural, E ◆✧ Emulsion (requires catalyzed talent)
4. Primary Spell Effect — the Effect + energy type this Subtype most naturally governs
5. Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule — the specific mechanical rules that apply when using this Subtype

Catalyzed states (✧ and E) require either: (a) the Forge-Access Talent, (b) a catalyzed planar artifact, or (c) operating within a Forge-dominant territorial expression. Without access, the caster may know the theory but cannot express it in spellcraft.

The Borderlands — Engine of Matter

Dominant defines physical state. Recessive defines behaviour. These are the elemental subtypes — they replace and expand Fire, Cold, Earth, Air, Water, Electricity, and Acid in their planar expressions. A caster with Borderlands Subtypes works in pure physics: they impose matter-states on reality.

Single-Plane Borderlands States

THE BORDERLANDS — Single-Plane States (B-01 to B-16)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
B-01	The Bedrock	◆	Earth · Matter	Permanence: Damage(Earth) to structures ignores Hardness. Protection(B-01) grants resistance to forced movement. Create(B-01) produces stone that lasts until destroyed, not until duration expires.
B-02	Magma	◆	Fire+Earth · Flowing Ruin	Dual-type (Fire/Earth). On hit, target suffers Lingering Area fire damage as magma clings. Affliction(B-02) applies Entangled as cooled stone encases limbs.
B-03	Acid	◆	Acid+Earth · Dissolution	Acid Subtype gains Incurable on armour damage. Damage(B-03) reduces effective AR by 1 per hit (cumulative, restored by Healing). Transform(B-03) dissolves stone and metal objects.
B-04	Dust	⚙	Air+Earth · Erosion	Catalyzed. Damage(B-04) bypasses solid barriers (gas phase carries grit through cracks). Affliction(B-04): Blinded + Choking (stacks). Requires Forge-access or catalyzed talent.
B-05	The Abyss	◆	Water · Crushing Depth	Damage(B-05) scales with depth: targets fully submerged take +2 bonus damage dice. Protection(B-05) grants pressure immunity. Affliction(B-05): Pinned (hydraulic weight).
B-06	Vapor	⚙	Water+Fire · Choking Fog	Catalyzed. Environment(B-06) creates concealment fog; targets inside take ongoing minor acid/heat damage. Cannot be dispersed by wind (pressure-sealed). Requires Forge-access.
B-07	Mire	◆	Water+Earth · Bog	Affliction(B-07): Entangled, save each round at cumulative -1. Difficult terrain persists. Targets failing 3 saves are Restrained

				(pulled under). Synergises with Lingering Area.
B-08	Hail	◆	Water+Air · Freezing Impact	Physical+Cold dual. Affliction(B-08) on failed save: Staggered (ice underfoot). Damage(B-08) has Penetrating vs. fire-based Protection (ice punctures thermal wards).
B-09	The Void Sky	◆	Air · Weightlessness	Flight(B-09) costs -1 CP (natural medium). Affliction(B-09): Disoriented (no ground reference). Projectile spells with B-09 Subtype gain extended Range one tier for free.
B-10	Current	◆	Air+Fire · Storm	Electricity+Air dual. Chain Additive costs -1 CP when applied to B-10 spells (lightning arcs naturally). Affliction(B-10): Deafened + Staggered (thunder-shock).
B-11	Frost	◆	Air+Water · Flash-Freeze	Cold Subtype. Targets hit must save or lose one action (frozen joints). Affliction(B-11) at Degree 3: Petrified (flash-frozen solid, not dead — thaws when force removed).
B-12	Erosion	⚙	Air+Earth · Abrasive Wind	Catalyzed. Damage(B-12) ignores worn armour (strips it). Each hit reduces AR by 1. Affliction(B-12): Blinded (grit). Cannot be Subtle — audible howl. Requires Forge-access.
B-13	The Inferno	◆	Fire · Pure Combustion	Damage(B-13) maximises fire dice on a crit (all dice read max). Ignite Additive costs -1 CP. Environment(B-13): zone deals automatic fire damage each round to all inside.
B-14	Scorch	◆	Fire+Air · Solar Wind	No fuel requirement — Damage(B-14) works in vacuum or anti-magic zones (it IS elemental physics, not magic cast on physics). Concealment(B-14): mirages and heat-haze.
B-15	Slag	◆	Fire+Earth · Superheated Matter	Damage(B-15): targets in metal armour take +1 die (conduction). Affliction(B-15): Weakened (heat exhaustion). Transform(B-15) melts metals without destroying them (reshaped).
B-16	Steam	⚙	Fire+Water · Pressurised Vapor	Catalyzed. Damage(B-16) fills enclosed spaces (area auto-expands to room if indoors). Affliction(B-16): Blinded + Scalded (ongoing). Requires Forge-access.

Borderlands Cross-Planar States

BORDERLANDS — Cross-Planar Natural States				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
CP-01	Animism	CP ♦	Life · Purposeful Elements	Elements gain biological drive. Fire(Animism) hunts targets rather than spreading randomly — rerolls miss once. Earth(Animism) Damage counts as Living for Healing spells (reversible).
CP-03	Fossilization	CP ♦	Stasis · Absolute Stillness	Affliction(Fossilization): target frozen mid-action — all ongoing effects on them pause, not end. On Degree 3: Petrified variant where the freeze is permanent until specifically dispelled.
CP-10	Artifact Terrain	CP ♦	Artifice · Machine-Geography	Environment(Artifact Terrain) creates zones that process ÆP: spells cast inside are Quickened or gain Secondary Effect (GM determines which per zone). Summon(Artifact Terrain) pulls constructs, not creatures.

The Verdant Font — Engine of Life

Dominant defines the organism. Recessive defines the behaviour. Verdant Font Subtypes are the biological subtypes — they expand Life, Animal, Plant, Poison, and Disease into full cosmological specificity. A caster with Font Subtypes works in biological imperative: growth, adaptation, consumption, infection.

Single-Plane Verdant Font States

THE VERDANT FONT — Single-Plane States (V-01 to V-16)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
V-01	The World Tree	◆	Plant · Infinite Canopy	Summon(V-01) produces flora-constructs. Create(V-01) wood never rots — permanent. Roots generated by V-01 spells cannot be cut by non-magical means (hardness scales with ESL).
V-02	Carnivorous	◆	Plant+Animal · Hunting Flora	Affliction(V-02): Grappled by living vines — vines deal automatic damage each round held. Triggered Additive pairs naturally (vines wait, then strike). Damage is Slashing+Piercing.
V-03	The Spore	◆	Plant+Myco · Pollen-Haze	Area effect Subtype. Environment(V-03): spore cloud causes Affliction(Confused) to all who breathe. Disease Subtype spells cast through V-03 zones gain Penetrating for free.
V-04	Overgrowth	⚙	Plant+Viral · Instant Reclamation	Catalyzed. Environment(V-04) reclaims structures: stone walls gain Difficult Terrain, fortifications lose cover rating in minutes. Damage vs. objects only. Requires Forge-access.
V-09	The Mycelium	◆	Myco · Underground Network	Communication(V-09) through connected soil: unlimited range underground, no LoS required. Senses(V-09) via network: perceive any location sharing soil connection. No aerial range.
V-10	Rot-Garden	◆	Myco+Plant · Sweet Decay	Healing(Rot-Garden): restores HP by accelerating biological regeneration — but recipient smells of decay for duration. Damage(Rot-Garden) bypasses undead immunity (rot attacks what is living within them).
V-11	The Hive	⚙	Myco+Animal · Fungal Control	Catalyzed. Affliction(Hive): Degree 3 = Controlled (caster directs target's actions). Target

				retains awareness (horror). Innate Additive raises cost +2. Requires Forge-access.
V-12	Plague	◆	Myco+Viral · Weaponised Disease	Disease Subtype. Persistent Additive costs -1 CP (disease naturally resists cure). Affliction(Plague) spreads: each affected target becomes a secondary source (contagion, GM tracks).
V-13	The Cancer	◆	Viral · Unchecked Growth	Growth(Cancer) effect doubles in size each round (Tethered required). Damage(Cancer) to structure: walls, floors grow and seal exits. Affliction(Cancer) Degree 3: fused-in-place.
V-14	Bioluminescence	⚙	Viral+Plant · Glowing Mutation	Catalyzed. Feature(Bioluminescence): grants low-light vision + emits faint light (negates Stealth). Affliction(Bioluminescence): target glows — cannot Hide, all attacks gain +2 to-hit them. Requires Forge-access.
V-15	Titan	◆	Viral+Animal · Kaiju Growth	Growth(Titan) removes size cap — targets can exceed Colossal. Each size step grants +2 Strength, -2 Dexterity, +4 HP per ESL. Damage(Titan) against normal creatures gains Overwhelming.
V-16	Mutagen	◆	Viral+Myco · DNA Rewrite	Transform(Mutagen) is permanent unless reversed. Affliction(Mutagen): random mutation each round (GM table). Panacea(Mutagen) cures mutations; Healing cannot. Alchemical Secondary Subtype pairs naturally.
V-05	The Hunt	◆	Animal · Pure Darwinism	Homing Additive costs -1 CP (predator tracking). Summon(Hunt) creatures have +2 attack and Scent. Damage(Hunt) ignores cover (predators flank). Affliction(Hunt): Frightened.
V-06	Sylvan	◆	Animal+Plant · Symbiosis	Enhanced Trait(Sylvan) buffs two attributes for price of one (symbiotic efficiency). Summon(Sylvan): summoned creatures arrive bonded to nearest plant-feature (grants Difficult Terrain cover).
V-07	Cordyceps	⚙	Animal+Myco · Piloted Body	Catalyzed. Affliction(Cordyceps): Degree 2 = Dominated (body controlled, mind suppressed not destroyed). Insidious +2 included by default. Requires

				Forge-access. High ESL requirement.
V-08	Chimera	◆	Animal+Viral · Biological Chaos	Transform(Chimera) applies random animal traits (GM table, 1d6 per ESL). Affliction(Chimera): target's body becomes unpredictable — roll on mutation table each round. Unstable Subtractive grants -2 CP.

Verdant Font Cross-Planar States

VERDANT FONT — Cross-Planar Natural States				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
CP-02	Adaptive Flesh	CP ◆	Life+Earth · Elemental Biology	Enhanced Trait(Adaptive Flesh) grants elemental resistance matching local environment automatically. Healing(Adaptive Flesh) in a matching elemental zone costs -1 ÆP.
CP-05	The Living Myth	CP ◆	Life+Fate · Narrative Biology	Summon(Living Myth): creature summoned is exactly what the narrative requires (GM determines form). Healing(Living Myth): cures the condition the target most needs cured, without specifying.
CP-12	Natural Machinery	CP ◆	Life+Artifice · Bio-Engineering	Comprehend(Natural Machinery) allows reading biological systems as engineering schematics. Construct targets become valid for Healing spells. Artifice+Life dual Subtype.

The Synod of Endings — Engine of Death

Dominant defines what remains. Recessive defines what lingers. Synod Subtypes expand Death/Undeath, Time (as decay), and Archive into the specific character of different kinds of ending. A caster with Synod Subtypes works in the grammar of cessation — what stops, what persists, and what is forgotten.

Single-Plane Synod States

THE SYNOD OF ENDINGS — Single-Plane States (S-01 to S-16)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
S-01	The Grave	◆	Death · Infinite Bone	Create(Grave) produces bone material of any shape — harder than stone at high ESL. Damage(Grave) counts as Bludgeoning+Necrotic. Protection(Grave): bone armour that reforms when broken (Regeneration Additive built-in at +1 CP).
S-02	The Ossuary	◆	Death+Archive · Scrimshaw Memory	Lore/Gnosis Secondary Subtype. Senses(Ossuary): read the history imprinted on any bone or physical remains (age, cause of death, last memories). Mind Reading(Ossuary) works on dead targets.
S-03	The Husk	◆	Death+Void · More Dead Than Dead	Nullify(Husk) strips all magical enchantments from a target (counts as magic-stripping, not dispel). Affliction(Husk): target loses one condition track permanently unless treated with Panacea(Restoration). Horrifying.
S-04	Necropolis	⚙	Death+Spirit · Undead City	Catalyzed. Summon(Necropolis) animates structural elements (walls, pillars) as undead constructs. Environment(Necropolis): zone reanimates all corpses as minor undead at start of each round. Requires Forge-access.
S-05	The Record	◆	Archive · Infinite Library	Comprehend(Record): reads any written or spoken language, past or present. Remote Sensing(Record): observe any event that was witnessed and recorded in any medium. Lore is the paired Secondary Subtype.
S-06	Whispers	◆	Archive+Spirit · Voice of Forbidden Knowledge	Communication(Whispers): transmits information that cannot be refused — target must hear it (no save vs. reception, only vs.

				compulsion to act). Affliction(Whispers): Confused (information overload).
S-07	The Reliquary	◆	Archive+Death · Sacred Remains as Data	Feature(Reliquary): imbues object with recorded memory — object becomes retrievable information storage. Senses(Reliquary): extract memories from physical objects left at death scenes. Psionic pairs naturally.
S-08	The Censor	⚙	Archive+Void · Records Consumed	Catalyzed. Nullify(Censor): erases target spell from caster's memory (they must relearn it). Affliction(Censor): Amnesia — target loses access to a skill or known spell for duration. Requires Forge-access.
S-09	The Haunt	◆	Spirit · Pure Emotion of the Dead	Affliction(Haunt): Frightened. At Degree 3: Panicked. Emotion Secondary Subtype pairs naturally. Senses(Haunt): perceive the emotional residue left by death at a location. Concealment(Haunt): target becomes ghostly-visible only.
S-10	Shadow	◆	Spirit+Void · Wraith-State	Shadow/Darkness Primary Subtype overlap. Damage(Shadow) drains light and warmth — cold damage + extinguishes non-magical light in burst. Affliction(Shadow): Weakened (hope-drained, penalty to Will saves).
S-11	The Echo	◆	Spirit+Archive · Living Memory-Replay	Illusion(Echo): creates a perfect sensory replay of a past event witnessed at this location (no save — it is real memory, not fabrication). Remote Sensing(Echo): past-scriving, not present. Duration is the memory's length.
S-12	Possession	⚙	Spirit+Death · Ghost in the Shell	Catalyzed. Insubstantial Additive included at -1 CP when cast by spirit-type caster. Affliction(Possession) Degree 3: Controlled by an external spirit. Requires Vessel Subtractive mandatory. Requires Forge-access.
S-13	Oblivion	◆	Void · Entropy Demonstrated Locally	Damage(Oblivion) cannot be healed by normal Healing — requires Panacea or Restoration magic. Weaken(Oblivion) drains ÆP from target (they lose pool points per round). Nihilism ethos anchor.
S-14	Decay	◆	Void+Death · Entropy of Physical Structure	Damage(Decay) destroys objects: bypasses all object Hardness.

				Affliction(Decay): Aged (target ages 1d10 years per degree; cosmetic at 1-2, mechanical at 3). Transform(Decay): reduces objects to dust.
S-15	Hollow	◆	Void+Spirit · Identity Consumed	Affliction(Hollow): Degree 1 — Confused; Degree 2 — loses name (cannot be identified magically); Degree 3 — Faceless (loses personality, becomes empty vessel). Insidious Additive costs -1 CP.
S-16	Amnesia	⚙	Void+Archive · Memory Hole	Catalyzed. Affliction(Amnesia): target loses one specific memory (caster designates). At Degree 3: loses entire skill ranks in one chosen skill. Insidious included. Memory cannot be restored by Healing. Requires Forge-access.

Synod Cross-Planar States

SYNOD OF ENDINGS — Cross-Planar Natural States				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
CP-04	Entropic Weather	CP ◆	Death+Earth · Decay Via Element	Environment(Entropic Weather): zone causes rapid aging of all objects inside — metal rusts, wood rots, stone crumbles over minutes. Living targets in zone must save each round or gain Degree 1 Affliction(Decay).
CP-07	The Inevitable Record	CP ◆	Death+Fate · Fate Scripted by Death	Luck Control(Inevitable Record): set a fate-line that ends in a specific death-condition. Prophecy(Inevitable Record): reveal the exact cause and moment of a target's death (Chronosynclastic pairing).
CP-14	Applied Remains	CP ◆	Death+Artifice · Necro-Machine	Summon(Applied Remains): constructs built from remains retain operational memory of their original form — a hand animates with its owner's skills. Construct targets are valid for Healing(Applied Remains).

The Hidden Forge — Engine of Technology

Dominant defines the power source. Recessive defines the aesthetic. All 16 Forge single-plane states are natural (◆) — within the Forge's own domain, making incompatible things work together IS the natural state. No internal Forge state is catalyzed. A caster with Forge Subtypes works in applied function: they impose purpose on raw force.

Special Rule — The Forge as Catalyst: The Hidden Forge also functions as the enabling condition for all Emulsion states.

Single-Plane Hidden Forge States

THE HIDDEN FORGE — Single-Plane States (F-01 to F-16, all natural)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
F-01	The Spire	◆	Crystal · Psionic Resonance	Psionic Secondary Subtype pairs at -1 CP. Create(Spire): crystal structures that passively store information — anyone touching them accesses stored spells (library function). Senses(Spire): resonance detection.
F-02	The Serum	◆	Crystal+Chem · Injectable Resonance	Alchemical Secondary Subtype. Enhanced Trait(Serum): effect delivered via injection, bypasses magical wards (not magical delivery). Affliction(Serum): introduces specific vulnerability to crystal-resonance magic.
F-03	Data	◆	Crystal+Volt · Memory Shards	Senses(Data): reads magical information stored in crystal. Create(Data): produces data-crystal recording current moment. Remote Sensing(Data) via stored crystal: past-scriving of recorded moment only.
F-04	Lens	◆	Crystal+Steam · Focused Resonance	Natural within Forge. Damage(Lens): piercing beam — ignores soft cover, halves hard cover bonus. Create(Lens): optic construct that amplifies allied spells passing through it (+1 ESL to passing spells).
F-05	The Vat	◆	Chem · Alchemical Potential	Alchemical Secondary Subtype at no extra cost. Transform(Vat): refines base materials into higher-grade components. Damage(Vat): acid/chemical, bypasses fire resistance. Healing(Vat): delivers as injectable compound.
F-06	Hydraulic	◆	Chem+Steam · Pressure-Fluid Power	Enhanced Trait(Hydraulic): Strength bonus powered by

				pressure — stacks with Sōmaturgic. Move Object(Hydraulic): moves objects via fluid pressure, no telekinetic signature (mundane-appearing).
F-07	Mana-Punk	◆	Chem+Crystal · Liquid Magic Pipeline	Create(Mana-Punk): ÆP-conducting pipelines — allies touching pipeline restore 1 ÆP per round. Protection(Mana-Punk): ward draws power from infrastructure rather than caster's pool (costs 0 ÆP per round if connected).
F-08	Galvanism	◆	Chem+Volt · Reanimation Science	Natural within Forge. Healing(Galvanism) works on constructs and undead (electricity as life-proxy). Immortality(Galvanism): creates reanimation condition — death triggers electrical restart (lich-adjacent).
F-09	The Engine	◆	Steam · Industrial Heartbeat	Feature(Engine): mechanical advantage — actions using constructed tools gain bonus. Environment(Engine): industrial zone, all physical tasks take half time. Summon(Engine): mechanical constructs.
F-10	Steampunk	◆	Steam+Volt · Tesla-Coal Science	Electricity+Pressure dual. Damage(Steampunk) ignores grounding (both pressure and electricity simultaneously). Create(Steampunk): devices that generate ongoing electrical discharge. Unstable -2 CP is optional.
F-11	Diesel	◆	Steam+Chem · Combustion Mechanics	Damage(Diesel): fire+impact — explosion effect, hits adjacent squares at half damage. Move Object(Diesel): treaded locomotion, can move objects over difficult terrain without penalty.
F-12	Aether-Tech	◆	Steam+Crystal · Pressure-Resonance Vessels	Natural within Forge. Create(Aether-Tech): vehicles and vessels using solar/Æthermal sails — flight without magic expenditure per round (structural investment). Requires Forge talent access for full expression.
F-13	The Grid	◆	Volt · Living Lightning	Environment(Grid): zone deals automatic Electricity damage to metal-wearing targets. Speed(Grid): electrical movement, ignores difficult terrain. Damage(Grid): Chain Additive costs -1 CP.

F-14	Cyberpunk	◆	Volt+Crystal · Neon Hard-Light	Illusion(Cyberpunk): hard-light constructs — they have physical mass (can be walked on, provide cover). Create(Cyberpunk): semi-permanent holographic structures at ESL×2 HP. Light Subtype overlap.
F-15	Clockwork	◆	Volt+Steam · Precision Droids	Summon(Clockwork) constructs have +2 Initiative (electric reflexes). Enhanced Trait(Clockwork): Dexterity + one other. Transform(Clockwork): converts organic targets into partially mechanical (grants Construct traits for duration).
F-16	Battery	◆	Volt+Chem · Corrosive Power Storage	Natural within Forge. Feature(Battery): spell stores ÆP for later release (caster banks points, recipient uses them). Damage(Battery): Acid+Electricity dual, Unstable optional for -2 CP. High energy yield, high instability.

Hidden Forge Cross-Planar States

HIDDEN FORGE — Cross-Planar Natural States				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
CP-09	The Elemental Engine	CP ◆	Artifice+Matter · Technology on Raw Elements	Damage(Elemental Engine): no conversion loss — volcanic/storm power direct. Cannot be turned off (no Toggleable Additive). Extreme power ceiling, extreme risk. Uncontrolled Parameter Subtractive recommended.
CP-11	The Biopunk Interface	CP ◆	Artifice+Life · Biological Technology	Healing(Biopunk Interface) applies to constructs. Summon(Biopunk Interface): creature-machines that evolve — gain +1 to a random stat each day active. Feature(Biopunk): self-repair (Regeneration built-in at -1 CP).
CP-13	The Derelict	CP ◆	Artifice+Death · Memory of Function	Summon(Derelict): ancient constructs operating on inertia — no ÆP maintenance cost (Tethered at 0 cost), but cannot be directed, only pointed. Feature(Derelict): objects function past their destruction point for 1d4 rounds.
CP-15	Clockwork Fate	CP ◆	Artifice+Fate · Deterministic Calculation	Luck Control(Clockwork Fate): calculate probability mechanically — always reroll, take better result (not luck, computation). Remote

				Sensing(Clockwork Fate): predict one future event with mechanical precision (not prophecy — physics forward).
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The Palimpsest — Engine of Narrative

Dominant defines the rules. Recessive defines the distortion. Palimpsest Subtypes expand Fate, Time (as narrative), Imagination, and Illusion into the specific characters of different kinds of story-logic. A caster with Palimpsest Subtypes works in probability and narrative weight: they impose story-structure on causality.

Single-Plane Palimpsest States

THE PALIMPSEST — Single-Plane States (P-01 to P-16)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
P-01	The Loop	◆	Fate · Temporal Trap	Affliction(Loop) Degree 3: target relives same round repeatedly until save broken (Groundhog Day trap). Luck Control(Loop): lock a single dice result — that result persists for duration.
P-02	Haunt	◆	Fate+Veil · Past Bleeding Through	Illusion(Haunt): overlays the true past event onto the present location — witnesses see both simultaneously. Senses(Haunt): read what happened in this exact spot. Differs from S-09 (The Haunt) — this is narrative echo, not emotional residue.
P-03	Nostalgia	◆	Fate+Glitch · Self-Reinforcing Past	Affliction(Nostalgia): target cannot perceive changes in their environment — they see a golden version of the present. Insidious included at -1 CP. Illusion(Nostalgia) cannot be disbelieved.
P-04	Corrupt	⚙	Fate+Probability · Degrading Memory	Catalyzed. Nullify(Corrupt): erases the most recently established magical effect in a zone (degrades newest first). Affliction(Corrupt): target's recall becomes unreliable — all memory-based skills halved. Requires Forge-access.
P-05	Dream	◆	Veil · Narrative Logic	Illusion(Dream): full sensory — dream-logic governs what is believed. No save vs. belief while inside (save only on exit or contradiction). Rules work if dramatically appropriate — GM has narrative authority.
P-06	Gambit	◆	Veil+Probability · Strategic Illusion	Illusion(Gambit): shows only the futures the caster wants the target to consider as viable. Luck Control(Gambit): manipulate perceived probability (target

				believes a low-probability outcome is guaranteed).
P-07	Fey Logic	◆	Veil+Fate · Deal-Physics	Feature(Fey Logic): binds agreements with physical consequence — breaking a Fey Logic-woven contract causes immediate Affliction(Degree 2). Rules are negotiable through deals; physics is not.
P-08	Horror	⚙	Veil+Glitch · Mask Slipping	Catalyzed. Affliction(Horror): Degree 1-2 Frightened; Degree 3 reveals eldritch truth — target gains one permanent Trauma. Illusion(Horror) cannot be sustained — it always breaks at the worst moment. Requires Forge-access.
P-09	Casino	◆	Probability · Pure Quantum	Luck Control(Casino): target rerolls any result — must take new result regardless. Feature(Casino): all spells cast in this Subtype's domain have 50% chance of critical success or critical failure (no middle ground).
P-10	Prophecy	◆	Probability+Fate · Hardened Fate	Remote Sensing(Prophecy): see a specific future event with high confidence (+4 accuracy). Luck Control(Prophecy): seal one fate-line — the sealed outcome is now Inevitable (extraordinary effort required to break).
P-11	Karma	◆	Probability+Veil · Visible Consequence	Feature(Karma): any action's consequence becomes immediately visible to caster. Affliction(Karma): target suffers their own last action reversed on them (attacker gets attacked, healer gets healed).
P-12	Chaos	⚙	Probability+Glitch · Broken Causality	Catalyzed. All spells with Chaos Subtype gain Unstable Subtractive for -3 CP (wild magic is structurally unstable). Luck Control(Chaos): cause and effect severed — target's actions produce random outcomes for duration. Requires Forge-access.
P-13	Error	◆	Glitch · Reality Breakdown	Nullify(Error): strips the physics of one object or creature (gravity, solidity). Damage(Error): pure reality-violation — no type, bypasses all typed resistances. Affliction(Error): target's actions produce incorrect results (GM adjudicates).
P-14	Paradox	◆	Glitch+Fate · Conflicting Timelines	Illusion(Paradox): two incompatible versions of target or object simultaneously true — observers must save or be

				Confused. Affliction(Paradox): target cannot affect objects (their timeline doesn't agree they're touching it).
P-15	Hazard	◆	Glitch+Probability · Systematic Failure	Environment(Hazard): zone — all safety margins fail. Objects break at worst moment, footing fails at critical moments. Affliction(Hazard): target's armour and defences fail at worst moment (GM determines when).
P-16	Simulation	⚙	Glitch+Veil · The Revealed Construct	Catalyzed. Illusion(Simulation): reveals the world IS constructed — target can briefly interact with the underlying code (rewrite one small fact about their environment). Affliction(Simulation): existential crisis — Stunned. Requires Forge-access.

Palimpsest Cross-Planar States

PALIMPSEST — Cross-Planar Natural States				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
CP-06	The Somatic Prophecy	CP ◆	Fate+Life · Body as Prophecy	Feature(Somatic Prophecy): target's body manifests their fate before it occurs — wounds appear before battles, aged features precede death. Senses(Somatic Prophecy): read target's physical fate from body inspection.
CP-08	The Forgotten Future	CP ◆	Fate+Death · Exhausted Possibility	Luck Control(Forgotten Future): permanently remove one outcome from the probability field — it cannot happen to target, ever (narrow scope). Affliction(Forgotten Future): target's number of future choices progressively narrows.
CP-16	The Glitch Machine	CP ◆	Fate+Artifice · Narrative Technology	Feature(Glitch Machine): machine or construct operates on narrative logic — it misfires dramatically, not mechanically. The misfire serves the story. Cannot be forced to be reliable (Unstable mandatory, no CP discount).

The Emulsions — Forbidden Alloys

Two antithetical planes forced together by a Hidden Forge catalyst. These are not environmental conditions — they are cosmological events expressed as spellcraft. Emulsion Subtypes require the Forge-Access Talent AND mastery of both constituent planes' Subtypes (minimum Subtype Tier 5 in each). They are the most powerful and most unstable Subtype category.

Emulsion Prerequisite: To use any Emulsion Subtype, a caster must have: (1) Forge-Access Talent, (2) Subtype Tier 5+ in at least one single-plane state from each constituent plane, (3) Overall Mastery 7+. Emulsion spells always carry the **◆⚙** tag — simultaneously natural (they follow physical laws of the forced combination) and catalyzed (they require Forge to sustain).

The Biotic Paradox (Verdant Font + Synod of Endings)

Life vs. Death. The Forge holds them apart while forcing them to interact. These are the reanimation and preservation schools at their most extreme cosmological expression.

EMULSIONS — The Biotic Paradox (Font + Synod)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
E-01	Amber Stasis	E ◆⚙	Life+Death · Preservation	Immortality(Amber Stasis): target frozen at moment of greatest vitality — not dead, not alive. Conscious, communicates psionically. Cannot be harmed while in stasis. Psionic Secondary Subtype included.
E-02	The Bloom	E ◆⚙	Life+Death · Fermentation Cycle	Healing(Bloom) converts necrotic damage into regenerative fuel — target heals when they take necrotic damage (cycle, not immunity). Environment(Bloom): zone where decay drives growth — death of one creature immediately heals all others in zone.
E-03	The Iron Lung	E ◆⚙	Life+Death · Life in Dead World	Protection(Iron Lung): creates sealed life-bubble in a death-zone — all inside are protected from Synod planar effects (and by extension, death magic). Requires Increased Action (-2) — the machinery takes time.
E-04	The Galvanic	E ◆⚙	Life+Death · Electrical Reanimation	Healing(Galvanic) works on dead tissue — Immortality(Galvanic) is the signature reanimation school. Body dead, charge alive. Damage(Galvanic) to undead: heals them (charge is life-proxy to Synod matter). Volatile.

The Reality Paradox (Borderlands + Palimpsest)

Matter vs. Fate. Objective physics vs. subjective narrative. These are the transmutation and reality-rewriting schools at their most extreme cosmological expression.

EMULSIONS — The Reality Paradox (Borderlands + Palimpsest)				
Code	Name	Type	Primary Spell Effect	Mechanical Signature / Subtype Rule
E-05	The Glitch-Spire	E ♦ ⚙	Matter+Fate · Filed Contradiction	Environment(Glitch-Spire): zone where both physics and narrative logic operate simultaneously. Within the zone: rooms can be bigger inside, gravity is directional, distance is negotiable. No one rule supersedes the other.
E-06	Alchemy	E ♦ ⚙	Matter+Fate · Narrative Transmutation	Transform(Alchemy): changes what something IS by rewriting its story — lead becomes gold not physically but cosmically. The transformed item functions as the new thing in every respect. Permanent at high ESL.
E-07	Clockwork Fate	E ♦ ⚙	Matter+Fate · Deterministic Chaos	Luck Control(Clockwork Fate Emulsion): raw elemental physics channelled into producing a predetermined narrative outcome. Volcanic pressure, storm-force, geological weight — all directed at making one specific future occur. Overwhelming Subtractive optional for +4 CP.
E-08	Hard Light	E ♦ ⚙	Matter+Fate · Digitised Matter	Create(Hard Light): objects that can be "downloaded" (stored in crystal or data-medium) and "uploaded" (reinstantiated). Insubstantial(Hard Light): matter becomes information briefly — passes through barriers as data.

Cross-Reference: Planar Subtypes by Effect

The following cross-reference allows a caster to find all Planar Subtypes that pair naturally with a specific Effect, making spell construction faster during play.

Damage

Best natural pairings: B-01 (Bedrock — structure), B-13 (Inferno — fire max), B-14 (Scorch — physics-only), S-03 (Husk — stripping), S-13 (Oblivion — unhealable), S-14 (Decay — hardness bypass), P-13 (Error — typeless), E-04 (Galvanic — reanimation dual), E-07 (Clockwork Fate — elemental directed).

Affliction

Best natural pairings: B-07 (Mire — Entangled progressive), B-11 (Frost — Petrified), V-11 (Hive — Controlled), S-15 (Hollow — Identity loss), P-01 (Loop — temporal trap), P-06 (Gambit — perceived probability), P-11 (Karma — reversal), P-14 (Paradox — timeline conflict).

Illusion

Best natural pairings: P-02 (Haunt — past overlay), P-03 (Nostalgia — unbreakable belief), P-05 (Dream — narrative logic), P-06 (Gambit — strategic), P-14 (Paradox — dual timelines), F-14 (Cyberpunk — hard light), S-11 (Echo — memory replay), E-05 (Glitch-Spire — filed contradiction).

Summon

Best natural pairings: V-05 (Hunt — predator), V-06 (Sylvan — symbiotic), F-09 (Engine — mechanical), F-15 (Clockwork — precise), S-01 (Grave — bone constructs), S-04 (Necropolis — structural undead, catalyzed), CP-14 (Applied Remains — memory-constructs).

Healing

Best natural pairings: V-10 (Rot-Garden — works on undead), F-08 (Galvanism — constructs and undead), E-02 (Bloom — death-fuelled healing), E-04 (Galvanic — dead tissue), CP-11 (Biopunk Interface — constructs). Note: S-13 (Oblivion) damage specifically cannot be healed by standard Healing subtypes — only Panacea or Restoration.

Luck Control

Best natural pairings: P-09 (Casino — pure quantum), P-10 (Prophecy — sealed fate), P-11 (Karma — reversal), P-01 (Loop — locked result), CP-07 (Inevitable Record — death-fate), CP-08 (Forgotten Future — narrowing probability), E-07 (Clockwork Fate — elemental determinism), CP-15 (Clockwork Fate Forge — computed prediction).

Create

Best natural pairings: B-01 (Bedrock — permanent stone), V-01 (World Tree — permanent wood), F-01 (Spire — information-storage crystal), F-14 (Cyberpunk — hard light mass), S-01 (Grave — bone), E-06 (Alchemy — narrative transmutation), E-08 (Hard Light — downloadable objects).

Senses / Remote Sensing

Best natural pairings: V-09 (Mycelium — network underground), S-02 (Ossuary — death-history), S-05 (Record — witnessed history), S-07 (Reliquary — object memory), S-11 (Echo — past-scrying), P-10 (Prophecy — future precision), CP-15 (Clockwork Fate — mechanical prediction).

Design Notes: The Replacement Logic

~~The original Subtypes of the Ætherium Codex remain valid. Fire, Cold, Earth, Air, Water, Electricity, Acid, Mind, Life, Death, Time, Space, Fate, and so on — these are the broad spectrum versions. A caster who knows Fire knows a general combustion principle.~~

This replaces the original generalized list.

Catalyzed states aren't a different *kind* of magic — they're compound spells. A catalyzed state is a spell sentence that requires multiple Subtype slots filled simultaneously, with each Subtype acting as an independent tier cap.

So the existing interlocking cap mechanic — where $ESL = \text{the lesser of Effect Tier and Subtype Tier}$ — simply extends:

Natural state: $ESL = \min(\text{Effect Tier, Subtype Tier})$

Catalyzed state: $ESL = \min(\text{Effect Tier, Subtype A Tier, Catalyst Tier, Subtype B Tier})$

Steam = Fire + Forge-catalyst + Water. If you have Fire 7, Forge 4, Water 6, your Steam ESL cap is 4.

The catalyst is the bottleneck by design — it's the hardest component to develop because it's the thing doing the forcing.

What this means in practice:

A caster who wants to cast catalyzed states has to develop *three* Subtype Tiers instead of one. That's not just more XP — it's a fundamentally different build philosophy. You're not a Fire mage who also knows some Steam. You're someone who has invested deeply across Fire, Forge-expression, and Water simultaneously, and the payoff is access to a state that pure elemental casters can't reach.

The Forge as the universal catalyst tier also makes cosmological sense. Every catalyzed state in the system — across all five planes — requires Forge forcing. So the Forge Subtype isn't just one of 104 options. It's the catalyst slot in every catalyzed formula. Developing Forge Tier is the investment that unlocks the entire catalyzed tier of the system, but it still caps every compound spell you cast with it.

And it extends naturally to cross-planar and Emulsion states:

Cross-planar natural (CP): $ESL = \min(\text{Effect, Plane A dominant Subtype, Plane B recessive Subtype})$

Emulsion: $ESL = \min(\text{Effect, Antithetical Plane A, Forge catalyst, Antithetical Plane B})$

The Emulsions become the most demanding expressions in the system — four-way interlocking caps — which is exactly right for cosmological events expressed as spellcraft.

The Political Alloy overlay is the Secondary Subtype slot — already in the system. The Ætherium Codex already has a Secondary Subtype category described as "the underlying magical philosophy or technique used to shape the spell — the *how* and *why*, not just the *what*." The Divine Values list is included (Sovereignty/Pragmatism from Aurelion, Strategy/Suffering from Bellum Hegemon, etc.) is remaining functioning as this layer.

What you're doing is expanding that Secondary Subtype list to include the full Political Alloy vocabulary — governance types, economic models, and ethos values — as valid flavoring options.

What it does and doesn't do mechanically:

It doesn't add a third tier cap. It doesn't gate ESL. It contributes to the sentence's meaning — the *why* of the spell — without becoming another bottleneck in the interlocking cap formula.

So the full spell sentence can now read:

Effect + Primary Subtype(s) + [Forge catalyst if catalyzed] + Secondary Subtype (Political Alloy overlay)

And the ESL formula remains:

$ESL = \min(\text{Effect Tier, Primary Subtype Tier(s), [Catalyst Tier if present]})$

The Secondary Subtype sits outside the cap calculation entirely. It's pure qualification — the adjective that tells you *how this civilization casts fire*, not whether the fire is stronger.

What the Political Alloy Secondary Subtype actually does:

This is where it gets interesting. If it adds no mechanical weight, it needs to do *something* beyond flavor or it becomes vestigial. I'd suggest it functions the way the existing Secondary Subtypes do — it defines the *resistance profile and recognition signature* of the spell. A Stratocracy-flavored fire spell and a Theocracy-flavored fire spell are both fire. But:

- A Deepguard ward keyed to Stratocracy expressions detects the former and not the latter
- A character with Comprehend or Senses can identify the civilizational origin of the magic
- Nullify spells can be keyed to Political Alloy Secondary Subtypes, meaning you can counter *a specific civilization's magic* rather than just a raw element

This makes the Secondary Subtype meaningful for the setting's institutional magic — Deepguard's wards, Chronosynclastic's probability models, Praxis's CDC function — without making it a power variable.